

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Microsoft Sentinel | Security Monitoring | Log Ingestion and Parsing | Threat Intelligence

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, security monitoring, log ingestion, and threat-informed detection across complex enterprise environments. I have hands-on technical ownership of Microsoft Sentinel, including data connector configuration, log parsing, analytics rule development using Kusto Query Language (KQL), workbook creation, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook design. I also hold expert-level proficiency in CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and have led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender deployment across an 8,000-user estate. I have a strong understanding of financial services security requirements, having delivered security engineering at HICX Solutions Ltd, a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech organisation, and I am well-versed in the threat actors, Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) relevant to financial services and regulated organisations. I am an effective remote collaborator with a proven ability to work independently and deliver security outcomes at pace without close supervision.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering and Log Management:** Microsoft Sentinel (data connectors, log ingestion, parsing, KQL analytics rules, workbooks, SOAR playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; log source onboarding, normalisation, monitoring, and alert management
- **Security Monitoring and Detection:** SIEM alert triage and response, detection engineering, correlation rule development, anomaly detection, behavioural analytics; CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, Microsoft Sentinel analytics
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender / Defender XDR
- **Incident Response and Threat Intelligence:** Incident response aligned to NIST 800-61; threat actor analysis and TTP mapping using MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat hunting informed by current adversary intelligence
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scanning, risk-based prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Security Tooling:** Mimecast email security gateway, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium, Check Point Harmony, PowerShell scripting, Splunk/SPL
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Own and manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM end-to-end, including onboarding new log sources via data connectors, configuring log ingestion pipelines, developing KQL-based parsing rules and analytics detections, and maintaining workbook dashboards for operational visibility.

- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR platform, including agent deployment, log ingestion, event normalisation, custom detection authoring, and threat hunting operations using Falcon Insight.
- Monitor, triage, and respond to security alerts across SIEM, EDR, and email security gateway platforms, investigating events, correlating indicators, and executing containment and remediation actions.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting informed by current threat intelligence and adversary Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, identifying threats that evade automated controls.
- Lead security incident response aligned to NIST 800-61, performing root-cause analysis, forensic investigation, containment, eradication, and post-incident reporting for significant security events.
- Design and deploy SOAR automation using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps and PowerShell scripting, automating alert enrichment, triage, and response for common threat patterns to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across the estate, overseeing integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified telemetry and correlated alert management.
- Administer Microsoft Entra Identity / Azure AD Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and SSO configurations alongside BeyondTrust PAM for privileged account governance.
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised reporting and coordinating remediation with technical teams.
- Manage Mimecast email security gateway, enforcing inbound/outbound filtering, anti-phishing policies, and data loss prevention rules.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Performed security monitoring and SIEM alert triage across enterprise log sources, investigating security events and escalating confirmed incidents in line with response playbooks.
- Developed and tuned SIEM correlation rules and analytics detections, improving detection fidelity and reducing false positive rates to manageable levels.
- Conducted threat hunting exercises aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, proactively analysing endpoint, network, and identity telemetry for indicators of compromise and threat actor activity.
- Supported log onboarding and ingestion processes, ensuring coverage of key data sources including endpoint, network, and identity within the SIEM environment.
- Administered Azure AD / Entra Identity IAM functions, managing access lifecycle, MFA rollout, and SSO integrations for staff and student populations.
- Supported vulnerability scanning operations using Nessus and AppCheck, triaging findings and coordinating remediation with infrastructure and application owners.
- Contributed to the BeyondTrust PAM onboarding programme, assisting with configuration, policy design, and privileged user training.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Delivered security engineering in a regulated Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech cloud environment, implementing endpoint security, identity management, and network security controls appropriate to financial services risk requirements.
- Managed security monitoring, log management, and alerting activities, building foundational detection and response processes in a fast-paced technology business.
- Applied knowledge of financial services business processes and associated threat actors to align security controls to the organisation's risk profile and regulatory obligations.
- Coordinated vulnerability scanning and tracked remediation of identified weaknesses across cloud and on-premises infrastructure, supporting compliance with regulatory security requirements.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment at UAL, onboarding diverse log sources, developing a library of KQL analytics rules, and establishing automated SOAR response workflows that materially reduced MTTR.
- Led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Defender for Identity deployment across an 8,000-user estate, integrating with Microsoft Sentinel for unified XDR telemetry and correlated incident management.
- Established a structured threat hunting programme using Microsoft Sentinel KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying previously undetected threat actor activity through hypothesis-led analysis of log and endpoint telemetry.
- Engineered and deployed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating standing privileged credentials and enforcing just-in-time access to reduce the privileged attack surface.
- Delivered a vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, achieving systematic identification and prioritised remediation of critical and high-severity findings across the estate.
- Developed PowerShell-based automation scripts and SOAR playbooks that automated alert enrichment and initial triage for high-volume alert categories, significantly improving analyst throughput and response consistency.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.), Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP75,000-90,000 | Remote (UK)